جامعة خليفة
Khalifa University

Khalifa University Libraries Procedures for Public Services

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Opening and Closing Procedures

The library entrance gate should be opened by the on-duty security guard. The library must be supervised by library staff throughout operating hours.

Opening procedures

- Prepare circulation computers by opening the RFID reader and the circulation module in Alma .
- Check in any books left in the book drop boxes.
- Check for books returned at all self-service kiosks and put on shelving trolley.
- Ensure that the copiers and printers are loaded with paper and ready to use.
- Look for any notes from the evening staff as to any special conditions or events that occurred from the night before. If there are any urgent notices, alert a librarian
- Check the incoming mail bags and process as needed.
- Check the holds list, if there is a request, retrieve the book, check it in and place it in the appropriate transit area.
- Take all items from "lost and found" to the campus Reception.
- Make sure gates are working properly.
- Take a quick look around the library to make sure that everything is ready for use. If anything is broken or needs to be fixed, submit a request to the help desk and make sure colleagues are notified.

Closing Procedures

- At 30 minutes before closing, collect any unshelved items. If there is time, re-shelve the items.
- Any personal property that is found should be taken to the Circulation Desk and placed in the "Lost and Found" area.
- At 15 to 20 minutes before closing time, politely remind users of the time left for closing.
- Write in the communication book any information that may be useful for the opening staff the next day.
- Wait for Security to close the Library door before leaving. Staff should not leave the Library while there are still students or security inside the Library.

Library Statistics

Keeping track of the Library statistics gives library management an incentive to make changes and decisions based on these statistics. The statistics are divided into two categories:

Library Headcount

Staff working at the service desk perform a headcount of patrons in the library every hour. The number counted are recorded in the worksheet found in the library shared folder at: \\Dept\Lib\Public Service\Statistics\HeadCount\[current year]\[current semester]\

Reference Questions

All public library staff are responsible for marking down reference questions. Questions are divided into various categories: directional, which are simple questions that take no more than a few seconds to answer (e.g. "Where is the toilet", "Can I borrow a pencil", etc.), and reference, which require more time (e.g. "How do I find books about Russia", "How can I change the settings in the printer?" etc.). The actual wording of all reference questions should be noted and entered into LibAnswers. All statistics are to be entered in LibInsight at https://kustar.libinsight.com/datasetr.php?id=15779.

Visitor Requests

According to the visitor policy, individuals who are not part of the KU community may request visitor access to the libraries. Those who want to visit should go to the library's visitor webpage (http://libguides.kustar.ac.ae/visitors) and download the application form. They should complete the form and return the form and the required documents to the library via the Circulation email account (circulation@ku.ac.ae). All requests will be forwarded to the library management for approval. Once approved, University Security will be notified to allow the visitor access to campus.

Phone Etiquette and Procedures

Phone etiquette is an important part of customer service. What is said and how it's said can instantly form a positive or negative impression for the person on the other end of the phone. It's important to be quick, efficient, and professional when answering user needs.

Always answer the phone with an appropriate greeting and identifying statement—for example, say "[your building] Circulation Desk, this is [your name]. How can I help you?" Always mention that you're in the library so that the caller knows where they've just called.

Circulation Rules

Both the number of items that may be borrowed at one time and the duration of the loans are determined by the patron type and the item type. The rules are defined as shown in the below table:

		Item Type					
Patron		Book	Periodical	Multimedia	2 Hour	1 Day	3 Day

	Faculty	20 items / 1 Semester	3 items / 3 days	3 items/ 3 days	3 items / 2 hours	3 items / 1 day	3 items / 3 days
	Staff	10 items / 1 Semester	3 items / 3 days	3 items/ 3 days	4 items / 2 hours	4 items / 1 day	4 items / 3 days
	Graduate Student	10 items / 1 Semester	3 items / 3 days	3 items/ 3 days	5 items / 2 hours	5 items / 1 day	5 items / 3 days
	Undergraduate Student	10 items / 14 days	May not borrow	3 items/ 3 days	6 items / 2 hours	6 items / 1 day	6 items / 3 days

Overdue Notifications

Automatic notices are sent to patrons for items that are due soon and three times for overdue items. Once items are six weeks overdue, assigned staff will send out a manual notice. If the items are still not returned, then a second manual notice is sent at eight weeks overdue. Templates for the overdue notices are in the library shared folder (\\Dept\Lib\Public Services\Overdue Notice Templates)

If items are still not returned, they are marked in Alma as lost and a bill is sent to the users for the replacement cost, plus 5% VAT, plus a processing fee of 50 AED per item. The billing process is done at:

- 6 months overdue for undergraduates
- 12 months for everyone else (graduates, faculty, staff)

Recalling Items

Library staff may recall checked out materials before the due date, and users will be notified of recall via email or phone.

Hold Rules

Only circulating materials may be placed on hold. Items that are currently checked in may be placed on hold as well as checked out material, items being processed or items on order. On hold items will be held not more than seven days. Multimedia, periodicals, and reserved items cannot be placed on hold.

Return Claims

The term "Return Claim" refers to an item that a patron claims to have returned but it's still marked as checked out their account in the library system. In this case, the below steps will be followed:

- Add a note to the patron's record, with the date, noting that they claimed to have returned the item(s).
- The item(s) must be searched for thoroughly by public services staff within a period of one week.
- If the item is found within that week, the item will be checked in and the note removed from the patron's record. If the item was not found within one week, it will be considered as lost and the user will be billed accordingly.
- Public services staff should notify users about the outcome of the search.

Payment for of Lost or Damaged Library Items

Any item checked out to a user's account is the full responsibility of that person. In cases when an item is lost or severely damaged, the user shall have to pay for the full cost of replacing the item. When staff is informed of a lost item, a block is placed on the user's account until settlement has been made.

The item cost is determined by taking the current price from the item/order record or other reliable source such as the contracted vendor and converted to dirhams (using 1 USD = 3.675 AED). An additional 5% VAT will be added to this price.

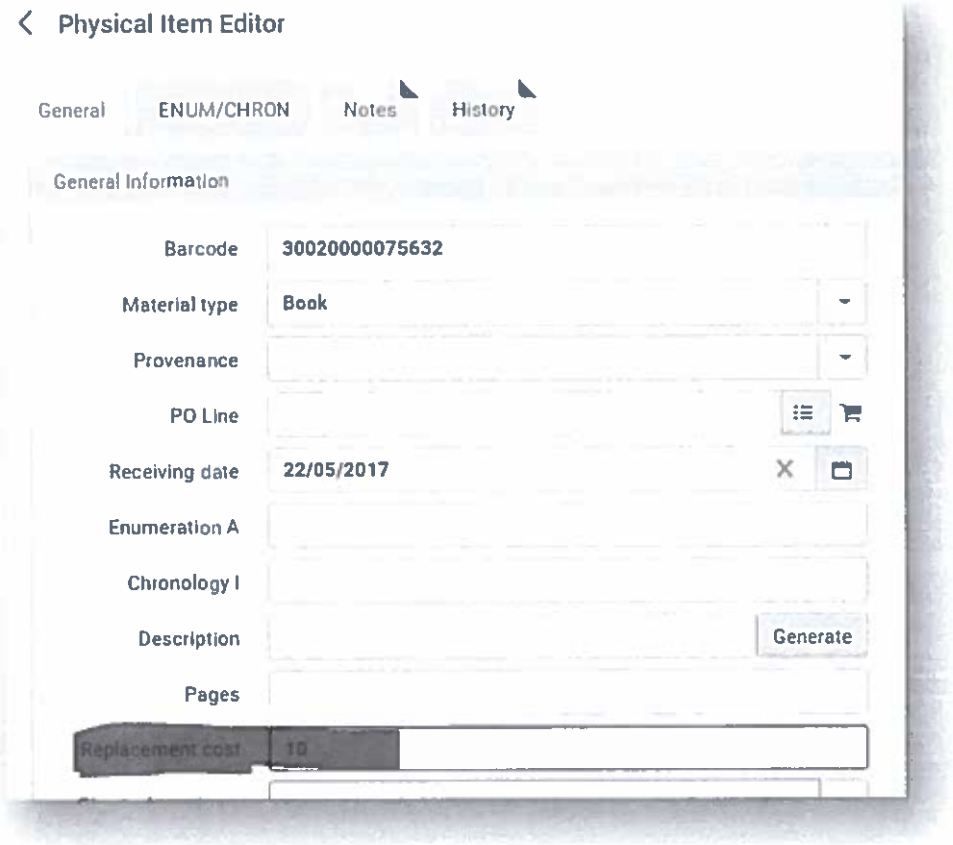
Also, an additional 50 AED (+ 2.50 AED VAT) replacement processing fee is added to this price.

The Circulation Desk will contact the user who has lost the item to inform them of the total cost of replacement.

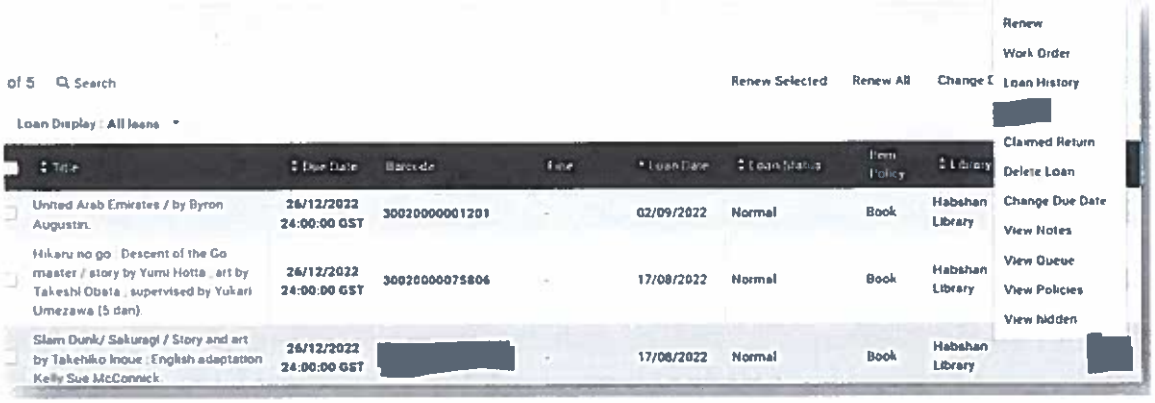
Payment of lost and damaged items:

1. Determine the price of the missing item(s) using the method stated above.
2. Find the user's record in "Manage Patron Services"
3. Click on the barcode of the item that has been lost or damaged

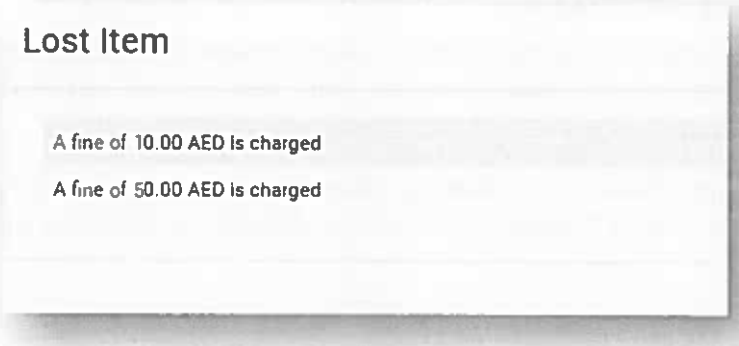
4. Enter the cost found in step one in the "Replacement Cost" field, and save the record



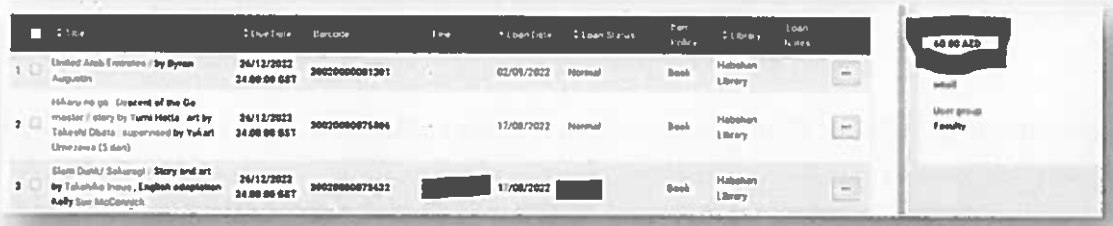
5. From the list of loans in the patron's record, click the button with three dots at the end of the item that is lost. Click on "Lost"



6. There should be a popup message that shows the replacement cost and the 50 AED service charge.



7. When the user's record reloads, the total fees will show under their name, and the book that is lost will now show a status of "Lost" and show the replacement fee plus the service charge.



Reimbursing Lost Book Payments

In case the user loses and pays for an item, but later finds the book, the user has no option to receive a refund for the amount paid, as per Finance Department directions.

Library Clearance

Clearance for KU employees are processed online. An email with the link of the clearance is sent to the proper staff for their action. Any book that is still under the users account will show on the form. If items are still out, the person should be notified and given a chance to return the items. If the items cannot be returned, then the price of the books should be deducted on the clearance form, in the case of employees, or the clearance is not processed until the items are returned or paid for, in the case of students.

ILL/Document Delivery Services

Inter-Library Loan (ILL) is a service provided by the libraries to supply research resources that the libraries do not own. External services supply these resources. Only faculty, staff and graduate students may use ILL services.

Prior to making an ILL request, users should verify that the library does not have access to the desired item in the library holdings. The ILL team verifies the availability of the items before proceeding with any requests.

Users submit their requests via the online request form or by sending an email to the assigned ILL account (ill@ku.ac.ae). If librarians receive a request via other channels (LibChat, email, e-form, etc.), they should forward the request to the ILL email account and inform the patron of the correct procedure.

Once a request is forwarded to the ILL team, other library personnel should not become involved in fulfilling the request, as this will only confuse the patron.

Requested articles in electronic format are delivered to the requestor electronically.

Requests for physical items should be made as a request to purchase new material, via the online form: https://library.ku.ac.ae/requesttitle/

The library will attempt to get any item for users as soon as possible, however, turnaround time depends on availability of the items. Items that violate the cultural or legal standards of the UAE should not be requested via ILL or document delivery.

Workshops

Khalifa University Libraries are committed to provide all faculty, students and staff self-development opportunities to ensure continuous learning and career growth in line with individual aspirations and university goals.

Types of workshops

KU Library staff conduct several types of workshop for the university community about using library resources, including:

- Orientation and introduction to the library
- Library databases training workshops
- Citation management tools
- Research Data management
- Library Events
- Topics related to research methods and best practices

The staff also conduct training and workshops to develop staff skills, both for library staff and university staff as a whole, including SQL, introduction to HTML, scratch programming, graphic design, Photoshop, how to create posters.

The library also conducts social meetings that encourage library use, including book clubs, quiz nights, library marathons, reading corners and other events.

Planning

KU libraries out-reach team meets before the beginning of the Fall and Spring semester to discuss topics, location, timing and presenters and make a plan proposal.

The team then send the proposal to the management to comment, suggest, and approve the plan.

When the plan is approved, all workshops and events are added to the library events calendar (https://kustar.libcal.com/calendar/events/) Instructions on how to add events to the calendar can be found at \\DEPT\LIB\Public Service\LibCal.

Notices and Evaluations

Two days prior to each event, the library will send an announcement to targeted audience using the email template thru libse@ku.ac.ae for workshops and events announcement. The announcement should include a brief description about the topic, location, date and time, the workshop registration link and the live streaming link.

All workshops will be conducted in the main campus library.

A day after each workshop, an evaluation survey will be sent automatically by email to all registered people. Instructions on using the evaluation system can be found at \\Dept\Lib\Public Service\LibCal\.

All evaluation survey results will be gathered and reported to the library director.

Web Portal

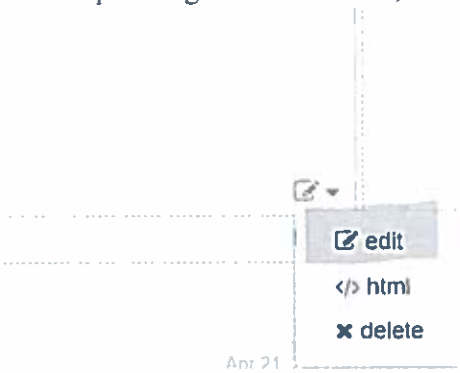
The library uses LibGuides (from Springshare) as the CMS (content management system) for its webpages. The URL for the homepage is http://library.ku.ac.ae.

All library web pages, except the homepage, use a template named "KU Redesign - Subpages" in LibGuides. This template provides most of the page's material (e.g. header image, menu bar for navigation, Quick Links, AskUs widget, library hours, etc.). The content specific to that page is placed on the page using the CMS's RTE (rich text editor).

To edit an existing page's content

1. Navigate to the page's public URL.
2. Click on the "**Login to LibApps**" link at the bottom of the page. This will load the editing interface for the page.

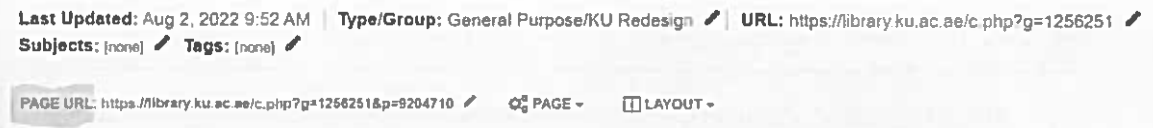
3. The "**Content Area**" of the page is the only part of the page that can be edited in this mode.
4. Most pages only have one text box in the Content Area, but some may have more than one or even other types of content. Regardless, to edit the content, scroll to the bottom of the content and click on the edit icon (which looks like a pen and notepad and has an arrow pointing down next to it).



5. Always pick the "**edit**" option, even if you want to edit HTML directly. You can choose to edit the HTML from the edit option, but if you make an error after choosing the HTML option directly, you may make the page unusable.
6. After clicking on edit, the CMS's RTE will appear, allowing you to add, change or remove the page's text, images, links, etc.
7. After making your changes, click the "**Save and Close**" button to commit the changes.

To create a new page

1. Go to the LibGuides dashboard page: https://kustar.libapps.com/libguides/admin.php
2. Click on "**Content**" on the menu bar.
3. Pick "**Guides**" from the submenu.
4. Click the "**Create Guide**" button beneath the menu bar.
5. Leave "**Start Fresh**" from the "**Choose Layout or Reuse**" option
6. Select the "KU Redesign – Subpages" template.
7. Enter the page name in the Guide Name box. This name will display on the page below the header image, so choose something appropriate and descriptive. For example, if your page is about the Year of Tolerance, then "Year of Tolerance" would be a great name.
8. Select "KU Redesign" as the Group Assignment.
9. Click the "**Create Guide**" button
10. When the page loads, it will not look like the other web pages yet. The page should just have your info box (a photo and info about you, the page creator). Delete that box by clicking on the 'X' at the top right of the box. Confirm that you want to delete the box. The page will reload without the box.
11. Click on the pencil to the right of the URL section (not in the address bar on the browser itself, but on the page – it is on the right hand side of the page, after "Last Updated" and "Type/Group").



12.
13. Pick a user friendly URL. For example, if your page was about the Year of Tolerance, then "tolerance" would be a good option to pick. You want something short and memorable. The new URL of the page will be http://libguides.kustar.ac.ae/[shortURL] ("http://libguides.kustar.ac.ae/tolerance", in our example).
14. There is a small menu bar near the top right of the page. The first option looks like a cog or gear. The next one looks like a photo. Pick that one.
15. Just to the right of the Quick Links, there will be a link called "**Add Top Box –**". Click that.
16. Make the box name "**Content Area**". Click the "**Floating Box**" option and then the "**Save**" button.
17. Click the "**Add/Reorder**" pulldown and pick "**Rich Text/HTML**".
18. Put whatever content you need into the RTE.
19. Click "**Save and Close**" to finish.
20. At the top right of the page, you will see a red "**Unpublished**" button. Click that and pick "**Change Status and Share**".
21. Change the publication status to "**Published**" and click the "**Save**" button next to it.
22. Your webpage is now live for the world to see.

To edit the template

Editing templates in LibGuides requires knowledge of HTML, because the template is only available in raw HTML (i.e. there is not an RTE). But if you know HTML, and you want to edit the template, this is how you do so.

1. Go to the LibGuides Dashboard page: https://kustar.libapps.com/libguides/admin.php
2. Click on "**Admin**" on the menu bar at the top of the page.
3. Pick "**Groups**" from the submenu.
4. Select the "**Edit Group**" option (an icon that looks like a pen and pad) for the "KU Redesign" group.
5. Select "**Look and Feel**" and "**Guide Pages**"
6. Click "**Customize Guide Templates**".
7. Select "KU Redesign – Subpages" from the pull down options.
8. The HTML code for the page will display in the Template Code box. You can now make your changes. Any changes you make here will be reflected on all the library web pages (except the home page, which uses a different template), so be very sure you know what you are doing.
9. Click "**Save changes to this template**" to commit your changes.

To edit the homepage's content

1. Go to the homepage's admin page (https://kustar.libapps.com/libguides/admin_c.php?g=1027921 or by navigating some other way)
2. Find the part of the content area you want to edit and use the edit icon (looks like a pen and pad) to access the RTE and follow the directions from the section "To edit an existing page's content" above.
3. In general, the only exception to this is the list of Library Events. These cannot be edited here, as they are automatically pulled from the library calendar (in LibCal).

To edit the homepage's template.

Follow the directions (and warnings) from the section "To edit the template" above, but instead of the "web page template", use the "new KU web template The current live template"

Newsletter

KU libraries started producing a monthly newsletter named "Bookends". The newsletter began in March 2018. It is published using Springshare application LibGuides. These LibGuides are created as a webpage to be added to the KU libraries website. The library publishes three issues a year.

Occasionally two issues may be merged. An email will be sent to all library staff asking for their contributions and if they have an article to publish.

Issues are usually published in the beginning of the month.

Special issues might be published for special events like UAE National day, month of reading, etc

Articles criteria:

- Articles should not exceed 500 words.
- Pictures (high quality), hyperlinks, websites, etc., should be tested and included.
- The deadline for submission of articles is one week from receiving the notification email.
- All contributions should be sent to libnewsletter@ku.ac.ae.

A group of library staff is responsible for creating and editing these bookends, they are called newsletter editorial board: first editor, second editor and designer.

The first editor will create a copy from the previous issue and rename it according to the month, volume and issue numbers.

Main sections of the newsletter are: (can be changed or replaced)

- Feature article
- Faculty Corner
- Librarian Corner

- Database spotlight
- E-book spotlight
- Book review
- Technology Bytes
- Quotable notable
- Did you know? (facts)
- And / or any contribution from library staff members

Fixed sections in all issues:

- Library hours
- Reference desk (highlighting important and most asked questions)
- Suggestions and feedback

When the editorial board is done adding the articles to the Bookend LibGuide, they send it to the library director for approval. Once approved, the status of the LibGuide will be changed to "published" and an email notification will be sent to the campus community. A screenshot and link will be added to the main library webpage and also to the drop down list under "Information".

Events & Outreach

The libraries organize events throughout the year to market the library and its resources, and to maintain its outreach vision. The libraries are also heavily involved with KU community events. Events organized by the libraries include:

- Month of Reading
- Quiz night
- Author's visit
- Book discussions
- Book Fair on campus

For events, an event initiation form is submitted through KU portal with the required details. For catering, a catering request is submitted. For leaflets, advertising, collaboration with the communications department is needed. For events that require outside visitors presenting to students, security clearances through the government relations office are needed.

Facilities management are consulted for logistical needs. Events are added to the calendar on the library portal & announced through libse@ku.ac.ae

LibChat and LibAnswers

LibChat and LibAnswers are services provided by the libraries through Springshare products. These allow users to get answers to their questions from a library without being present in the library.

LibAnswers is both a system where librarians can create FAQs that users can use to search for answers to questions that they have, and a system that allows users to submit questions if they cannot find an answer among the current answers. Users can search for answers or ask new ones at the LibAnswers public page: http://libanswers.kustar.ac.ae/ or from any library webpage when LibChat is not being monitored.

Answering questions submitted via LibAnswers:

When a question is submitted by a patron, all librarians assigned to the LibAnswer system will receive an email notification. This is a sample of what one of the emails looks like:

A new ticket has been submitted and is awaiting attention.

View this ticket at

http://libanswers.kustar.ac.ae/admin/ticket?qid=######.

Librarians should claim the ticket as soon as possible by opening the link in the email and responding to the request as appropriate.

Once a ticket is claimed, other staff should not interact with the patron unless the person who has claimed it asks for help. This will avoid confusing the patrons with multiple messages.

Answering Questions in LibChat

Librarians who are scheduled to monitor LibChat should log in to LibChat at the start of their workday by going to the LibAnswers dashboard (https://libanswers.kustar.ac.ae/admin/home?m=queue) and selecting "LibChat" from the menu bar and then choosing "Connect" from the submenu.

Once you are connected, you will hear an audible chime when users submit chat requests. Librarians should connect to chat requests as soon as possible by clicking on the request in the Chat Activity window, where the "Chat Waiting" will appear. Just click on the "Answer" button to respond.

Once connected to the chat, you may use any of the many saved "Canned Messages" that are available to reduce the amount of typing needed to respond. For example, there are several greetings, depending on the time of day. Find out what the question that the user has and respond to it the same as if the patron was in front of you in person.

LibChat Schedule

A schedule for the librarians who should be monitoring the LibChat queue during the day can be found at the LibAnswers dashboard page: https://libanswers.kustar.ac.ae/admin/home?m=queue. Staff who are working in the evening should also monitor the queue even when it is not their normal day.

Creating FAQ entries:

Whenever the need arises for a new entry into the FAQ entries, librarians can create them from the LibAnswers Dashboard: https://libanswers.kustar.ac.ae/admin/home?m=queue.

1. Select "Answers" from the menu bar at the top of the page.
2. Select "Create" from the submenu.
3. Pick the FAQ option.
4. Enter the Question text. Be as complete as possible – this will help patrons find the entry when they have similar questions.
5. Enter full details for the questions in the "Details" section.
6. Press the Continue button.
7. Enter the answer in the Answer textbox. You can add files, links, or media to help answer the question.
8. Add topics and keywords to the entry. This will also help future users find this entry.
9. Save the entry and change the status to published so that it can be seen by public users.

Reference Desk

KU librarians and professional staff answer reference requests from all users. They provide reference and research services during working hours by the online library reference service AskUs, LibAnswer or in person.

To ensure consistent, high-quality reference services to all KU library users and to provide guidelines on handling patrons' requests, the following standards will be maintained:

1. All users' inquiries will be handled in a courteous and professional manner.
2. Inquiries from patrons may be received by telephone, Web forms, e-mail, chat, or in person. Reference services will be provided in a manner that is timely and responsive to the needs of the requester. The length of time required to answer a question will be determined by its complexity and the needs of the individual patron.

3. KU Libraries librarians will respond to patron inquiries in the following priority order:
   - All non-rush or regular reference inquiries will be answered promptly to meet the patron's information needs. KU Libraries librarians and professional staff will evaluate the inquiry and inform the patron of anticipated response time if the request cannot be answered within the same business day.
   - All rush reference requests will be given priority status. All rush requests will be discussed with the patron and an agreed-upon timeframe for response will be established together to ensure that the needs of the patron are met.

- For extensive research requests, an estimate time of completion will be provided to the requester by the next business day.

4. Patrons must be kept informed on the status of their request.
5. Patrons will be provided with options or alternatives for other sources if the information they are seeking is not available in the library or included in the resources available.

Information Literacy Program

KU libraries have a thriving Information Literacy (IL) program that covers all levels of the university community, including staff and faculty. With more than 15 modules covering all aspects of the effective use of library resources, there is something for everyone. Librarians meet with department representatives in the Preparatory English & Undergraduate English sections and Graduate Office before the academic year starts to plan the first semester modules.

In the case of non-predetermined needs, faculty and librarians collaborate as and when a need for an IL session arises.

At the end of the Fall Semester, librarians and the department representatives meet again and plan for the following semester.

All libraries have 'Library Instruction' spaces to deliver IL sessions, and priority booking for these spaces is given to IL sessions.

Types of delivery

- One-to-one - Librarians are available to all students, faculty and staff on a one-to-one basis. Appointments are encouraged.
- Booked classes – predetermined & part of an IL course
- Booked classes – As the need arises/one-off
- Workshops – targeting the entire university community
  - Librarians coordinate with vendors for workshops on newly acquired databases/resources.
  - Librarians plan and deliver around 8 workshops per semester
- Orientation & library tours, especially at the start of an Academic Year.

Target audiences

- Preparatory students
- Undergraduate & Graduate
- Senior design students
- Faculty (workshops & one-to-one)
- New faculty (orientation)
- New students (orientation)
- Staff (workshops & one-to-one)

Student Workers & Volunteers

KU libraries encourage students to volunteer by using their community services hours to help in the libraries, especially with projects such as inventories and physical shifting of collections, shelving and any other required work. The libraries also hire student workers, where students are paid for working in the libraries.

The policy and all forms for student workers and volunteers are kept in the library shared folder at \\Dept\Lib\Administration\Student Workers & Volunteers

Volunteers

- Student enquires at circulation.
- Circulation staff hand out a 'student volunteer' form along with the 'student volunteer policy'.
- Student fills in the form with all details and hands back to circulation staff.
- Concerned staff make their decision based on the policy.
- Student is informed of the outcome of his/her application.
- A schedule is drawn by circulation staff in conjunction with the availability of the student.
- Student goes through an orientation session and training on the assigned tasks.
- Student signs in their worked hours, endorsed by the circulation staff.
- Circulation staff convey this information to 'Student Services' as evidence for students community service hours covered.

Workers

Student workers might cover night shifts, Saturday shifts and any other required hours. The procedures for hiring workers is a longer process:

- Student enquires at the library.
- Concerned staff get details from the student.
- Library Staff will check with the Student Services about students eligibility of working.
- Interviews will be scheduled by the Student Services, for students with concerned library staff.
- If the interview is a success, library submits the interview results and gets the go ahead from student services who checks grades, security, etc.
- Once approved, the following documents are submitted by the student to Student Services department:
    - No Objection Letter from Guardian for Female/Advisor
    - Bank Information – Account must be under your name
    - Emirates ID (both Sides)
    - Passport copy/Residence visa copy if applicable

- Upon completion of the above requirements, a contract is signed. A separate email for contract signature is sent to the student.

The Student Timesheet is filled by the student and approved by his/her library supervisor and submitted at the end of every month for payment to be processed. Any queries regarding contracts / payment is sent to student services.

Booking Rooms

Some library rooms are available for booking by anyone within the KU community. Rooms such as Instruction rooms might be needed for various reasons, by different departments or student clubs, for meetings, events, workshops and teaching Information Literacy.

Group Study Rooms

There are eighteen study rooms at MC library and nine at SAN library. All are bookable through an online system. The reservation request of the study rooms will be accommodated based on these terms:

- Staff/Faculty
  - If the purpose of request is to attend an online conference or online teaching
  - The reservation of room can be made for only 2 days.

- Students
  - Allowed to reserve room for a 2-hour time limit per day.
  - Rooms are open to all when not reserved/occupied; however, users with a valid reservation are given priority.
  - Reservations can only be made by online room booking system
  - No food permitted.
  - Furniture may not be moved out of these rooms.
  - Unattended items left on unreserved room will be removed and given to security.
  - Ensure of closing the doors and maintain reasonable sound level.
  - Rooms should be left clean and orderly.

If a room is being used by a male and female students, the light must remain on.

Cancelling/changing a room booking

If you need to cancel a room booking, simply click on the cancellation link in your confirmation email.

Once submitted, bookings may not be modified. To change a booking, you will need to cancel and rebook it.

Copies/Printers

Library users can avail of printing and copying facilities, including scanning and color printing in the libraries.

Circulation staff are responsible to replenish the copiers with paper and deal with any issues such as paper jam, etc. Any issue that cannot be solved is referred to the copy center engineer.

Inventory

An inventory of all physical items (i.e. books, multimedia, maps, etc.) at the library branches will take place at least every two years.

The physical part of the inventory will be conducted with the library's Bibliotecha handheld barcode scanners. Staff at each branch will try to scan every item's RFID tag. After approximately 1000 barcodes have been scanned, the list will be moved to the staff inventory coordinator's computer using the Smartstock software, both to make the scanner work faster (they start to run out of memory after more than 1000 barcodes) and to prevent data loss, as occasionally the data cannot be exported and the items have to be rescanned.

When all items have been scanned, the inventory coordinator will upload the scanned barcodes into Koha's built-in inventory functionality. The scanned barcodes should be broken up into smaller sections, as trying to do the entire collection at once would take a very long time and would cause performance delays for staff and users.

Each of these smaller files (of 10,000 items or so) must first be sorted by library branch and call number order. The collection code doesn't matter in this case, so you will have to mix the items from various collections together in the barcode list.

Save each file as a list of barcodes, one barcode to a line, with no other text, except that the first line should have the word "barcode".

Then in Alma:

1) Go to "Admin"
2) Select "Manage Sets"
3) Click "Add Set"
4) Pick "Itemized"
5) Enter a set name
6) Change the set type to "Physical items"
7) Upload the file from the scanned items.
8) Click save

The set will take a few minutes to be created. When the set creation is complete:

1) Go back to "Admin"
2) Select "Run a Job"
3) Select "Change Physical items information"
4) Press "Next"
5) Select the set that you created in the previous step.
6) Press "Next"
7) Check the box next to "Inventory Date"
8) Enter the date of the scanning of the items.
9) Leave condition set to "Unconditionally".
10) Press "Next"
11) Press "Submit".
12) Press "Confirm" to begin the job.

The job will take a few minutes to complete.

Approval Authority	Signature and Date
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Endorsed by **SVP Academics & Student Services** Dr. Ahmed Al Shoaibi	Ahmed 20/12/2022